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#### ARTICLE

China Fears The One Thing It Cannot Control-The Explosive Growth Of Christianity



BY PNW STAFF MAY 15, 2026

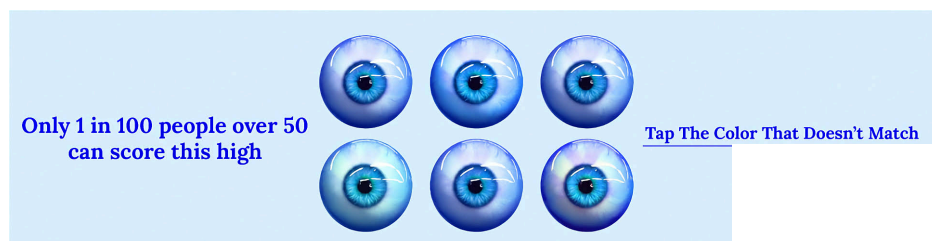
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As the world watches Donald Trump engage with China on trade, military power, artificial intelligence, and global influence, another story remains buried beneath the headlines -- the relentless and systematic persecution of the Christian church inside China. While diplomats shake hands and cameras flash, millions of Chinese believers continue to worship under surveillance, face imprisonment for their faith, and watch as the Communist Party attempts something few regimes in history have dared to do: rewrite the Bible itself.

For decades, the Chinese Communist Party has viewed Christianity not merely as a religion, but as a rival authority. The issue has never been theology alone. It is control. Any institution capable of commanding higher loyalty than the state is viewed as a threat. And with estimates now placing the number of Christians in China as high as 130 million -- surpassing the membership of the Chinese Communist Party itself -- the government's anxiety has only intensified.

What makes this remarkable is that Christianity in China has exploded despite decades of persecution. Underground house churches continue to multiply. Secret prayer meetings continue behind locked apartment doors. Rural revivals continue in hidden villages. The harder the state has tried to crush Christianity, the more the church has grown.



That growth has now triggered a far more aggressive campaign.

The Chinese government is no longer satisfied with tearing down crosses, arresting pastors, or shutting churches. It is now attempting to reshape Christianity into a state-approved ideology loyal first and foremost to communism. Under President Xi Jinping, the Communist

Party has aggressively pushed what it calls the "Sinicization" of religion -- a movement demanding that Christianity conform to "socialist values" and absolute loyalty to the Party.

One of the most chilling examples is the regime's effort to alter Scripture itself.

A Communist Party-approved textbook rewrote the story of the woman caught in adultery from John chapter 8. In the authentic biblical account, Jesus tells the crowd, "He who is without sin among you, let him cast the first stone." The accusers leave, and Jesus forgives the woman. But in the Party's revised version, Jesus stones the woman Himself and declares, "I am also a sinner."

It is difficult to overstate how shocking such a distortion is to Christians worldwide. This is not interpretation. It is ideological replacement. The goal is not simply to censor Christianity but to transform Jesus into a political servant of the state.

Tina Ramirez of Hardwired Global warned that China has "taken it to a new level" by attempting to rewrite Scripture itself in order to confuse believers and prevent conversions.

The campaign against Christianity extends far beyond rewritten texts.



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Children under 18 are banned from attending many churches in parts of China. Sunday schools and youth ministries have been raided or shut down. In several provinces, minors have reportedly been forbidden from entering church buildings entirely. Christian summer camps have been canceled. Youth Bible education has been heavily restricted. Authorities understand a simple reality: if children cannot learn Christianity young, the Party can better control the next generation.

Meanwhile, digital censorship has intensified. Bible apps have disappeared from Chinese app stores. Online Christian bookstores have been shut down. Some believers have resorted to secretly sharing downloaded PDF copies of Scripture because legally accessible versions have become harder to obtain.

The state-approved churches that remain open often function less like churches and more like political extensions of the Communist Party. Patriotic slogans praising communism hang beside crosses. Sermons are expected to promote loyalty to the state. Some churches have reportedly been instructed to sing songs celebrating the Communist Party before worship services begin.

Pastors who refuse compliance often disappear into prison.

Wang Yi, pastor of the underground Early Rain Covenant Church, was sentenced to nine years in prison after publicly criticizing government interference in Christianity. Members of his church were arrested alongside him. Others have faced house arrest, surveillance, intimidation, or economic punishment.

In provinces like Zhejiang, authorities have removed crosses from church rooftops and demolished church buildings entirely. Facial-recognition cameras have reportedly been installed inside some churches to monitor worshippers. In certain areas, Christians have been pressured to replace images of Jesus with portraits of Xi Jinping.

And yet, despite all of this, the underground church continues to grow.

That may be the most astonishing part of the story.

History repeatedly shows that persecution often strengthens the very faith governments seek to destroy. The Soviet Union failed to eradicate Christianity. North Korea has not eliminated it entirely despite horrific repression. And now China -- armed with AI surveillance, censorship technology, and enormous state power -- is discovering the same reality.

One Chinese pastor reportedly summarized it best: "The rulers have chosen an enemy that can never be imprisoned. They are doomed to lose."

As global leaders focus on tariffs, trade deals, and military strategy during Trump's visit, the spiritual battle unfolding inside China deserves equal attention. Beneath the economic superpower is a government terrified of faith it cannot fully control.

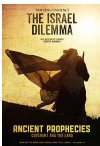
And despite surveillance cameras, rewritten Bibles, imprisoned pastors, banned children, and state propaganda, millions of Chinese Christians continue to gather quietly, pray faithfully, and believe defiantly.

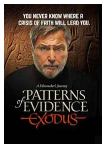
The Communist Party may control the streets, the schools, the media, and the prisons. But history suggests something it cannot easily control: a church willing to suffer for what it believes.

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